

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7 2
♥ Q 5 2
♦ K 8 7 4
♣ Q J T

♠ K 9 3

♥ 7 4

♦ Q J 6 5

♣ A 8 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ T 5

♥ K J 6

♦ A T 9 2

♣ K 9 5 4

♠ Q J 8 6 4

♥ A T 9 8 3

♦ 3

♣ 7 6

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2♦]

A perfect Michaels example; 5-5 in the Majors and 9 points. You bid 2♦ and partner says 2♠. What do you bid next? [BID pass]

[show NS]

West

North

East

South

1♦

2♦

Pass

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by North

you have for his ♠ suit, he doesn't **HAVE** a ♠ suit, he is just supporting yours. In other words, you pass.

You have a rather minimum Michaels type hand and you asked partner to choose a Major suit. He chose ♠s. But don't start thinking about what great support

Board 2

West Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 4
♥ Q
♦ Q 7 4 2
♣ K Q T 8 2

♠ A T 8 6 3
♥ A T 9 7 4
♦ 8 6
♣ 5



♠ 7 2
♥ J 6 5 2
♦ K 9 3
♣ A J 4 3

♠ J 9 5
♥ K 8 3
♦ A J T 5
♣ 9 7 6

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♥
All Pass			
2 ♥ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2♥]

[show NS]

You have a fair hand with a guaranteed 8-card fit in either Major. You are not, however, strong enough to jump the bidding. So you bid 2♥, which is passed out.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q T 8 3

♥ J T 5

♦ 5

♣ T 8 7 4

♠ A 6 4 2

♥ Q 8 7 3

♦ Q 3

♣ A 9 5



♠ J 9

♥ A K 6 4 2

♦ A J 8 6 2

♣ 2

♠ 7 5

♥ 9

♦ K T 9 7 4

♣ K Q J 6 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♣

1♥

2NT

All Pass

3♣ by North

showed nothing more than minimum. So you pass.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2NT]

You have a pretty good hand for an Unusual Notrump, but not so good that you wouldn't use the convention. You bid 2NT and partner says 3♣. What do you say next? [BID pass]

[show NS]

As mentioned, you have a pretty good hand, but partner only bid because you forced him to and he

Board 4

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q T 8 3 2
♥ K Q T
♦ A
♣ 8 6 3

♠ 9 6
♥ 4
♦ K Q J 8 4
♣ K Q T 7 5



♠ K 4
♥ 8 6 5 2
♦ T 7 3 2
♣ A 9 4

♠ J 7 5
♥ A J 9 7 3
♦ 9 6 5
♣ J 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	2NT	Pass	3 ♦
All Pass			
3 ♦ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3 ♦]

[show NS]

Your best suit is ♥s. But partner didn't ask you to bid ♥s, he asked you to pick a Minor. You know you will have an 8-card fit in ♦s so you take the safe approach and bid 3 ♦. Everybody passes.

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q T 5
 ♥ 6
 ♦ K Q J T 8 4
 ♣ 9 7 4

♠ 8 6 3

♥ K 7 5 3 2

♦ A 9 7 5

♣ Q

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K J 9 4 2

♥ A Q

♦ 3 2

♣ A 8 6

♠ 7

♥ J T 9 8 4

♦ 6

♣ K J T 5 3 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

get lucky and make this but it looks like the other guys are cold for 4♠. Even if partner loses 2♥ tricks and goes down 1 it will turn out to be a good sacrifice.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2♠]

Of course you bid a Michaels Cue-Bid of 2♠.

Partner says 4♥. What do you bid now? [BID pass]

[show NS]

Partner's jump might indicate he has a really good hand, or he might just have a really good fit. You certainly don't have the strength to make another move so you pass. A good thing, too. Partner might

Board 6

West Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 8 5
♥ Q 8 5 3 2
♦ A Q 4
♣ 7

♠ 7 4

♥ 6

♦ J 9 8 7 3

♣ A Q T 8 5

N

W E

S

♠ 9 3 2

♥ T 7 4

♦ T 5 2

♣ 9 6 4 3

♠ A K T 6

♥ A K J 9

♦ K 6

♣ K J 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3NT]

[show NS]

You have no idea what you can make with this hand. Slam in one of the minors may be possible, but maybe not. You decide to try 3NT.

Board 7

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 6 5 2

♥ 7 2

♦ 6

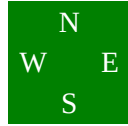
♣ 9 7 5 4 3

♠ A 9 3

♥ A 6

♦ Q 9 8 4 2

♣ K Q J



♠ Q T 4

♥ K T 5 3

♦ A 7

♣ A T 8 6

♠ 8 7

♥ Q J 9 8 4

♦ K J T 5 3

♣ 2

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2NT]

With the two lowest unbid suits you bid 2NT. Partner jumps to 4♦. What do you bid? [BID pass]

[show NS]

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♦

1♣

2NT

All Pass

4♦ by North

weaker. It is strictly a judgement call and we decide to pass.

Partner probably has a good hand, but he might just be preempting. Assuming he is inviting you to bid game you have a tough decision. You are not very strong but you might have been a couple of points

As you can see, **IF** they open the lead with a ♣, and **IF** the ♥ finesse then works, you can make 5♦.

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -
♥ A 8 5 3
♦ Q 9 8 4 3
♣ K Q 8 6

♠ K 9 8 7 4
♥ Q J T 9 6
♦ 5
♣ 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 5 3 2
♥ K 2
♦ K J T 2
♣ J 3 2

♠ A J T 6
♥ 7 4
♦ A 7 6
♣ A T 9 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	2 ♦	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3 ♠]

[show NS]

As you have figured out by now, using Michaels Cue-Bids / Unusual Notrump is sometimes hard to tie down. Here you have 13/14 points and if you figure partner for 9 that won't be enough for game. But, those two Minor Aces are worth a lot when you figure partner has only 3 Minor suit cards.

So let's say you decide to just invite with 3 ♠. Partner takes you to game.

You will surely make this game if trumps split 2-2. If they don't then you will have to hope for a defensive mistake.

Board 9

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 2
 ♥ K T 7 3 2
 ♦ -
 ♣ Q T 9 7 3

♠ K Q J 7
 ♥ 6
 ♦ 9 7 4
 ♣ K 8 6 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 9 8 4 3
 ♥ A 5
 ♦ A Q 8 6 2
 ♣ A

♠ T
 ♥ Q J 9 8 4
 ♦ K J T 5 3
 ♣ J 2

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	2 ♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3 ♦
All Pass			
3 ♦ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2 ♠]

With 5 cards in the "other" Major and a 5-card Minor you bid 2 ♠, Michaels of course. Partner bids 2NT. What do you say next? [BID 3 ♦]

[show NS]

Is it possible that partner wants to play Notrump? Not at all. He hates ♥s and wants you to bid your Minor suit. So you say 3 ♦ and he passes.

Board 10

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 8 2

♥ J 5

♦ A 9 2

♣ Q 8 7 2

♠ K Q

♥ A K Q 8 3

♦ Q J T 5 4

♣ 3



♠ J 7 5 4 3

♥ T 9 6 2

♦ 8

♣ K J 4

♠ T 6

♥ 7 4

♦ K 7 6 3

♣ A T 9 6 5

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3 ♦]

Partner asked you to choose between ♥s and ♦s so you bid 3 ♦. He then raises you to 4 ♦. What do you bid? [BID 5 ♦]

[show NS]

West

1 ♣

Pass

All Pass

5 ♦ by South

trumps. I'm a lot better than that.", then you will accept the invitation. So you bid 5 ♦ and everybody passes.

North

2NT

4 ♦

East

Pass

Pass

South

3 ♦

5 ♦

If you say to yourself "I only have 7 HCP" then you might pass. But if you say "Partner invited me to bid game, even though I might have no points and only 3

Board 11

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 2
 ♥ K T
 ♦ J 9 8 4 2
 ♣ T 9 4 2

♠ K T 9 3

♥ J 6 5 2

♦ K 6

♣ K Q 5



♠ 8 4

♥ A Q 8 7 4 3

♦ 7

♣ A J 8 7

♠ A Q J 6 5

♥ 9

♦ A Q T 5 3

♣ 6 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	2♥	1♥	1♠
All Pass		Pass	4♠
4♠ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 1♠]

With 5 cards in the "other" Major and a 5-card Minor suit this looks like an ideal Michaels Cue-Bid, right? No, not really. While it would not be a capital offense to bid 2♥ here, it generally works out better with 13-16 point hands to just overcall in your higher-ranking suit. You bid 1♠. Partner responds 2♥. What do you bid? [BID 4♠]

[show NS]

Partner's cue-bid shows a limit-raise or better in ♠s. So you bid 4♠ without the blink of an eye.

Board 12

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K 7
♥ A J 9 7 5
♦ Q J 6 4
♣ 9 2

♠ A T 9 8 3

♥ 8

♦ 7 5

♣ Q J T 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 5 4 2

♥ Q T 3

♦ A 8 2

♣ A 3

♠ 6

♥ K 6 4 2

♦ K T 9 3

♣ K 8 6 5

West

1 ♥

Pass

All Pass

3 ♣ by North

North

2 ♥

3 ♣

East

Pass

South

2NT

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2NT]

Partner is 5-5 in ♠s and one of the Minor suits.

Forget ♠s, you want him to bid the Minor. So you bid 2NT. Partner says 3 ♣. What do you bid now? [BID pass]

[show NS]

Partner only made a minimum bid, so you have no choice but to pass.

Board 13

East Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 4
 ♥ A 3 2
 ♦ T 4 2
 ♣ Q J 9 6

♠ 7 6 2

♥ J 9 5

♦ Q J 8

♣ 7 5 4 2



♠ Q T

♥ 8 6

♦ A K 9 7 6 3

♣ K T 8

♠ A K 8 5 3

♥ K Q T 7 4

♦ 5

♣ A 3

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	3 ♥
All Pass			

3 ♥ by North to bid. Any bid at all by you at this point will show 17+ points, so you just raise to 3 ♥. Partner has a weak hand and passes.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2 ♦]

With 18 points and 5-5 Major suits you are up in the high-level Michaels category. You bid 2 ♦ and partner responds 2 ♥. What do you bid next? [BID 3 ♥]

[show NS]

Yes, you have a high-level Michaels hand but don't get carried away. Remember that you forced partner to bid. Any bid at all by you at this point will show 17+ points, so you just raise to 3 ♥. Partner has a weak hand and passes.

Board 14

West Deals
None Vul

♠ A K
♥ J 7 2
♦ J 9 3
♣ K J 9 4 2

♠ 9 4
♥ A T 9 6 4
♦ K Q 6 5 2
♣ 8



♠ 3 2
♥ K Q 5
♦ A T 8
♣ Q T 7 5 3

♠ Q J T 8 7 6 5
♥ 8 3
♦ 7 4
♣ A 6

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	2NT	Pass	3 ♠
All Pass			
3 ♠ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3 ♠]

[show NS]

Partner wants you to bid ♥s or ♦s. You figure that in either of the red suits you will have a 7-card fit. You hope to do better than that in ♠s. So you bid 3 ♠ and everybody passes.

Board 15

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7
 ♥ T 9 2
 ♦ A Q J 9 8
 ♣ J T 2

♠ J 9 4 3

♥ J 6

♦ T 7 6 4

♣ 9 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 5

♥ 8 5 3

♦ K 3 2

♣ K Q 8 5 4

♠ K Q T 6 2

♥ A K Q 7 4

♦ 5

♣ A 3

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2♣]

You have 20 points and two good 5-card Majors so you bid a Michaels 2♣. Partner responds 2♠. What do you say next? [BID 4♠]

[show NS]

West	North	East	South
Pass	2♠	1♣	2♣
All Pass		Pass	4♠

4♠ by North

your hand you only need to find partner with ♠ J x x to have a good shot at game. So go ahead and bid 4♠.

Partner may have as few as zero points and as many as 13 or so. You **COULD** bid an invitational 3♠, but if he has only 5 or 6 points he will pass. Looking at

Will you look at that. Partner has only 2 points, but what great ones to have!

Board 16

West Deals
None Vul

♠ 3
♥ J 7 6
♦ A K Q 9 6 3
♣ Q J 8

♠ K 9 8 5 2
♥ A 9 4 3 2
♦ T 5
♣ 9



♠ Q J T 7 4
♥ 5
♦ J 8
♣ T 7 4 3 2

♠ A 6
♥ K Q T 8
♦ 7 4 2
♣ A K 6 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	2 ♦	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 4 ♥]

[show NS]

Partner has 5 of each Major suit so you know of a good 9-card ♥ fit. You have a nice hand and must decide between inviting with 3 ♥ or bidding the game on your own. You decide to bid the game so you say 4 ♥ and everybody passes.

Board 17

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6 5
 ♥ Q T 7 5 4 3
 ♦ T 4
 ♣ 2

♠ A 7 3

♥ A K

♦ A Q 6 3

♣ T 8 5 3



♠ Q J T 9 2

♥ J 9 8 2

♦ J 9

♣ A K

♠ 4

♥ 6

♦ K 8 7 5 2

♣ Q J 9 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
------	-------	------	-------

Pass	3♠	1♠	2NT
------	----	----	-----

Pass	5♣	Pass	4♣
------	----	------	----

All Pass

5♣ by South
partner raises to 5♣.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2NT]

This is a really good hand for Unusual Notrump. You bid 2NT and partner says 3♠. What do you say now? [BID 4♣]

[show NS]

Partner apparently has a big hand. His cue-bid is forcing, and probably means he wants to be in game. But for now you can just show your minimum strength and give a suit preference. You bid 4♣ and

Board 18

West Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 6 2
♥ Q T 3
♦ J 8
♣ A Q J 8

♠ Q J 7 5 3
♥ A 9 8 4 2
♦ K 5
♣ 4



♠ K 8
♥ K 7 5
♦ A 6 3
♣ T 9 7 3 2

♠ T 4
♥ J 6
♦ Q T 9 7 4 2
♣ K 6 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	2 ♣	3 ♣	
All Pass			
3 ♣ by West			

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID pass]

[show NS]

Many times at Bridge you want to fight for the contract. This isn't one of them. With 6 HCP and only four cards total in partner's two suits just let the opponents have it. You pass.

Board 19

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 8 4 3

♥ 8 4

♦ Q J 9 3

♣ T 6

♠ 7

♥ 6 2

♦ A 6 4

♣ A K Q 8 7 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J

♥ A J T 5

♦ K T 8 5 2

♣ 5 2

♠ Q T 6 5 2

♥ K Q 9 7 3

♦ 7

♣ J 9

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♣

All Pass

3♣ by North

you would be better in ♣s. So you pass.

1♦

2♦

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 2♦]

With two 5-card Majors of course you bid 2♦.

Partner responds 3♣. What do you say now? [BID pass]

[show NS]

This wasn't according to your script. Partner was supposed to choose a Major. The reason he didn't, of course, is that he didn't like either one and figured

Board 20

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 3
♥ Q J
♦ K Q J 9 3
♣ K Q 8 3

♠ K J T 5 2

♥ A 9 7 4 3

♦ 6 2

♣ T

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 6

♥ K 8 2

♦ A T 8 5 4

♣ J 6 4

♠ Q 8 7 4

♥ T 6 5

♦ 7

♣ A 9 7 5 2

West

1 ♦

All Pass

3 ♠ by South

North

2 ♦

East

3 ♦

South

3 ♠

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. It is your bid. What do you say? [BID 3 ♠]

[show NS]

You don't have a great hand but you **DO** have 4 ♠s. So don't let the opponents have a 3-level contract when your side has 9 ♠s. Bid 3 ♠.

Note: See the Law of Total Tricks Lesson on this topic.